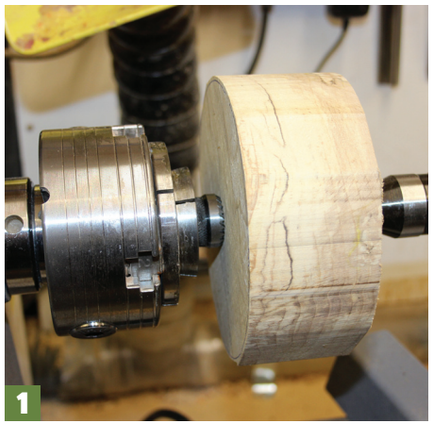
1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

1 This is a way to hold a blank if you don't want to have a screw or screw holes in your blank. I am holding this between centres; I have a steb centre held in the chuck and a revolving steb in the tailstock

2 Turn the waste away with the bowl gouge. Once most of this is removed, use the parting tool and skew chisel to cut the dovetail. Once completed you can turn the blank around to cut the other side. It will line up on the centre points of the steb centres

3 Place in the chuck and start to part down the centre with the parting tool to create the joint spigot, about two parting tool widths. Now start to part down at the side of the spigot, make a small clearance cut to stop the tool becoming jammed. Once you have parted halfway through, stop the lathe. Now use a small hand saw to finish separating the two halves. If you continued with the parting tool so deep the tool would become more uncontrollable to use

4 Part in where the base lip will fit, this is around 5mm deep. Now start to remove the waste for inside the top part with a bowl gouge, leaving some extra in the centre. Try for an even curve on the inside

5 As you can see, a lot of the waste has been removed now. Shape the centre part, this will be a feature and give a little more depth for the hole that will be drilled in the top for the finial

6 Use a round or French curve scraper to finish the inside; remember to use scrapers in a trailing mode, making sure that the handle is slightly higher than the tool tip. This will avoid a catch and give a better finish to reduce sanding later

7 Use the skew to finish the recess where the spigot or lip of the base will fit into, and also to add detail to the centre part as well. Hold the skew flat on the toolrest and in a horizontal mode to stop this catching. Now sand and seal the inside of the base to a finish standard

8 Take the top out of the chuck and hold the base in the chuck. Start to remove the waste from the centre with the bowl gouge. Don't forget to leave the spigot on the edge. This again is a gentle curve

HANDY HINTS

1. Always use a dust mask when working with MDF and typically timbers
2. Your tools will blunt more quickly with hard dense timber, so remember to sharpen your tools more often

WT_287_87_91_PROJECT_PHILIP_GREENWOODbdJRMBSD.indd 89 06/11/2015 11:06